

GREECE

Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Hellenic Republic
Short Form	Greece
Capital	Athens
Region (UN)	Western Europe and Others Group (WEOG)
Government Type	Parliamentary Republic
Head of State	President Katerina Sakellaropoulou
Head of Government	Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis
Currency	Euro (€)
UN Member Since	25 October 1945
MUN Standing	Influential middle power in Europe and the Mediterranean; often active in peacekeeping, refugee policy, maritime law, and regional cooperation. Supports human rights, EU multilateralism, and conflict mediation.



Book Recommendations

Title	Author(s)	Why It's Relevant
<i>Greece and the United Nations</i>	Xenophon Zolotas	Overview of Greece's diplomatic engagement and multilateral positioning.
<i>Greek Foreign Policy: From Independence to the Present</i>	Aristotle Tziampiris	Deep dive into regional strategy and international positioning.
<i>The Eastern Mediterranean in Transition</i>	Thanos Dokos (Ed.)	Covers maritime security, refugee issues, and conflict—all key UN agenda items.

<i>Migration and Refugee Policies in Greece</i>	Anna Triandafyllidou	Key reference for ECOSOC, UNHRC, and UNICEF topics.
<i>Europe and the Maritime World: A Twentieth-Century History</i>	Michael Miller	Maritime law and Greece's influence in UNCLOS and Security Council issues.

Greece: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Greece at the UNHRC – Geneva Mission	https://www.mfa.gr/missionsabroad/en/permanent-mission-geneva	Updates and statements from Greece's permanent mission in Geneva.
UNHRC – Member States Overview	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc/about-council	Background on the Human Rights Council's mandate and Greece's participation.
UN Web TV – Greece Statements at UNHRC	https://webtv.un.org/search?term=greece%20human%20rights%20council	Video footage of Greece's speeches and interactions during HRC sessions.
Greece's Universal Periodic Review (UPR)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/gr-index	Greece's latest self-report and responses to peer recommendations.
Office of the Greek Ombudsman	https://www.synigoros.gr/?i=human-rights.en	Independent institution overseeing civil rights and state compliance with human rights law.
Amnesty International –	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/greece/report-greece/	Monitors domestic issues like police violence, migrant

Greece Country Reports		rights, press freedom.
Human Rights Watch – Greece Analysis	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/greece	In-depth reporting on refugee policy, discrimination, and judicial reform.
Freedom House – Greece Country Rating	https://freedomhouse.org/country/greece/freedom-world/2023	Evaluates Greece's political rights, civil liberties, and media freedom.
National Commission for Human Rights (NCHR) – Greece	https://www.nchr.gr/en/	The national human rights institution coordinating with UNHRC mechanisms.

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review – Greece	OHCHR UPR Greece	Core UPR documents: reports, recommendations, state responses
UPR Info – Greece	UPR Info Greece Review	Documents, stakeholder submissions, NGO and UN inputs
OHCHR Greece Country Page	OHCHR Greece	Hub for treaty body reports, special procedures, and UPR
UNHCR Greece – Refugee Rights	UNHCR Greece	Information on asylum procedures, rights, and obligations
UNHCR Greece – Help Site	UNHCR Help Greece	Guidance for refugees and asylum-seekers in Greece
Human Rights Watch – Greece 2025 Report	HRW Greece 2025	Overview of human rights issues in Greece
Human Rights Watch – Greece 2024 Report	HRW Greece 2024	Analysis of human rights developments in Greece
Amnesty International – Greece Report	Amnesty Greece	Assessment of human rights conditions in Greece

Unique Aspects of Greece's UNHRC Engagement

1. Cradle of Democracy and Human Rights Philosophy

As the birthplace of democracy, philosophy, and political ethics, Greece's historical legacy gives it moral authority when advocating for democratic values and human rights at the UNHRC.

2. Frontline State in Europe's Migration Crisis

Greece has been a key entry point for refugees and migrants from the Middle East and Africa. It often raises the challenges of shared responsibility, humane treatment, and border rights at the UNHRC.

3. Advocate for Minority and Cultural Rights

Greece actively promotes the protection of minority cultures, languages, and identities, particularly in the Balkans, while working through complex issues surrounding the Muslim minority in Thrace.

4. Strong Focus on Gender Equality and Anti-Discrimination

Greece has significantly advanced women's rights, LGBTQ+ inclusion, and anti-discrimination policies, aligning itself with progressive EU human rights norms and pushing for them globally.

5. Vocal Supporter of Freedom of Religion and Belief

With deep Orthodox Christian roots but also a growing emphasis on pluralism, Greece promotes interfaith dialogue and tolerance, especially in regions facing religious persecution.

6. Regional Human Rights Mediator in the Balkans

Greece plays a diplomatic role in promoting stability, minority protections, and reconciliation in the Western Balkans, often bringing regional human rights concerns to the UNHRC's attention.

7. Promoter of Economic and Social Rights Amid Crisis

After experiencing its own financial crisis, Greece speaks from experience on how austerity measures can impact housing, healthcare, and employment — advocating economic justice as a human right.

8. Defender of Maritime and Sovereignty Rights

Greece frequently links territorial integrity and maritime rights (especially in the Aegean and Eastern Mediterranean) to the broader discourse on human rights and peace, especially regarding conflict prevention.

9. Host and Collaborator with Human Rights NGOs

Athens is a growing hub for human rights organizations dealing with migration, trafficking, and refugee rights, reflecting strong state–civil society partnerships in advancing UNHRC agendas.

10. Active Contributor to UN Human Rights Mechanisms

Greece regularly participates in the **Universal Periodic Review (UPR)** and supports special rapporteurs and treaty bodies, demonstrating transparency and commitment to human rights self-assessment.
